

Animal Production

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Animal Production (A11422)

Short Title:	Animal Production	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Land Sciences	
Cluster	Agriculture	
Author	JRYAN	
Credits	5	Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to acquire a basic knowledge and the skills needed for operating a modern beef, dairy or sheep farm. The student will learn about the feeding and management requirements of livestock. Students will gain an insight into animal health and welfare, operator health and safety, and good environmental practices.

Programmes

AGRI - 0004 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

1 / 2 / M

Indicative Content

- Milk quality and yield
- Dairy facilities
- Feeding & management dairy cows
- Diseases of cows
- Rearing replacement cows, breeding cattle
- Economics of dairy production
- Systems of lamb production and associated sheep tasks
- Diseases of sheep
- Economics of sheep production
- Feeding and management of sheep
- Suckler calf production
- Systems of cattle production and associated tasks
- Diseases of cattle
- Economics of cattle production
- Health & safety, First Aid

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Describe the management requirements of different animal production systems such as calf to beef, spring milk production and mid season sheep.
2. Complete safely operations associated with different animal production systems such as cattle to beef, spring milk production and mid season sheep with due regard to good environmental practice and the animal's health and welfare.
3. Describe good environmental practices in animal production.
4. Describe appropriate actions to promote and maintain good animal health and welfare.
5. Identify areas where improvement in animal production can be made on the farm.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,3,4
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	30%	2
<i>Assignment</i>	20%	5

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Will be able to show a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes.

50%-59%: As well as the above, the student will be able to demonstrate an understanding of some of the complexities of the topics.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of the all topics, and demonstrate an ability to evaluate detailed knowledge acquired in the module to new material.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, and evaluate and relate topics that overlap all of the learning outcomes.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	30	
Field Trips	18	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Hoyne , W. *_Introduction to Sheep Farming_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2008.
- Mc Carthy , J. *_Production and Marketing of Beef Cattle_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2008.
- McMonagle , J. *_Introduction to Farm Farm Animals_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2008.
- Moylan , P. *_Introduction to Dairy Farming_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2004.
- O' Halloran, J. *_Breeding & Calving Cows_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2008.
- Pettit , T. *_Food Assurance, Animal Health and Welfare_* . Oakpark: Teagasc, 2008.

Supplementary Material

- Boatfield , G. *_Farm Livestock_*. Oakpark: Farming Press, 1994.
- Ewbank , R. *_Management and Welfare of Farm Animals_*. UK: UFAW, 1999.
- Malcolm, B. *_Introduction to Practical Animal Breeding_*. UK: Blackwell Science, 1988.